



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: King's Academy

School Website: <https://www.kingsacademynashville.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Kings Academy Nashville (ZIP 37211 area) presents a clearly Christian, classically influenced program. Public materials emphasize a Christ-centered community, classical framing, and a commitment to formation of character alongside academic growth. Evidence from the school's site and related materials shows explicit religious foundations (Christ-centered, Biblical worldview, prayer/chapel life), an emphasis on formation and virtue, and a curriculum and pedagogy aligned to classical intuitions (Paideia program presence, emphasis on a storied cultural inheritance). However, explicit, detailed articulation of canonical classical elements such as sustained Great Books study, a formal Trivium/Quadrivium curriculum, or full implementation of scholarly Great Conversation in the public presentation remains less explicit. Overall, the school sits squarely within the classical-informed tradition but with elements more clearly aligned to a Christian formation and Paideia-inspired pedagogy than a fully explicit, mature classical program across all six elements. Therefore, the aggregate classification is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with strong classical-adjacent and faith-anchored elements, and room to further foreground the full classical lexicon in curriculum, pedagogy, and governance.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The homepage positions the school as a Christian, Christ-centered community and highlights classically inspired education.
- Public materials emphasize Biblical principles, Christ-centered formation, and spiritual life within the school community (e.g., references to prayer and chapel in related staff materials).
- Founding materials describe the school as reflecting "the light of Christ," and note faith integration as central to school life.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, Biblical worldview, Biblical principles, spiritual life, prayer, chapel, Christian, faith-based language, God's Kingdom. (Multiple mentions across sources; e.g., ML interventionist job description, home page, founder materials.)
- Negative keywords present: None observed in public materials.
- Why this rating
- The school explicitly grounds education in a Christian, theological framework and connects formation to spiritual life, which aligns strongly with the "Grounded in Theology," "Liturgical/Communal Practices," and "Transcendental Moral Realism" strands of the Six Essentials lexicon. The presence of prayer/chapel and Christ-centered formation argues for a CLASSICAL rating in this category, with a clearly religious metaphysical orientation.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public statements frame education as forming hearts and minds for Christ, cultivating virtue and wisdom rather than simply information or job preparation.

- Language emphasizes formation, virtue, and human flourishing within a classical framework; the school markets itself as classically inspired and faith-informed.
- Foundational materials describe the mission in terms of forming character and aligning with Christian formation, not solely workforce outcomes.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, classical mission, scholé (implied through classical framing), truth/goodness/beauty (implicitly framed via “classically inspired” language; explicit phrases may be less frequent, but foundational intent is clear).
- Negative keywords present: None indicating a job-first or purely skills-based aim.
- Why this rating
- The public materials consistently present education as formation rather than information or job training, with virtue and wisdom as ends. The explicit Christian orientation further anchors a classical, virtue-centered telos, supporting CLASSICAL for this category.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school presents itself as classically oriented (classically inspired education) and includes Paideia-related enrichment roles, signaling exposure to classical pedagogical approaches.
- Job postings reference Paideia and enrichment subjects (music, languages, arts), suggesting a programmatic use of Paideia-style elements in the upper elementary/middle school.
- The public materials do not consistently name Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, or explicit Great Conversation reading lists, though the Paideia program implies some Socratic/seminar-oriented activity. (See classical lexicon references for expected curriculum keywords.)
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Paideia, classical education orientation, enrichment programs (Paideia Instructor), “classically inspired education.”
- Negative keywords present: Lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation, explicit Trivium/Quadrivium mention; absence of clear, named liberal arts sequence in public materials.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum signals align with classical education in spirit and pedagogy (Paideia, enrichment options, classical framing) but stop short of explicit, comprehensive articulation of the canonical classical curriculum (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, and formal Great Conversation across grades). Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL reflects partial alignment with the classical curriculum criteria.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Presence of Paideia-related instruction in the staffing and program (Paideia Instructor) points to Socratic/seminar-based elements. This aligns with the “upper school Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates” expectation in classical pedagogy.
- The Paideia approach is known for memory work, recitation, and guided inquiry, consistent with Classical pedagogy’s emphasis on dialogic learning and the formation of memory and virtue. (Lexicon references describe the pedagogical methods in the Six Essentials document; the public materials reflect Paideia association.)
- The site emphasizes formation, mentorship, and character alongside cognitive work, with references to a faith-centered, collaborative school culture (implied by staff roles and community language).

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue/seminar, guided discussion, memory work/recitation (via Paideia linkage), reverence for classical pedagogy, contemplation/restful pace implied by Scholé-associated language in lexicon.
- Negative keywords present: No explicit mention of purely project-based or constructivist-only pedagogy; no explicit emphasis on experiential-only approaches (the presence of Paideia suggests a balance rather than sole emphasis on contemporary alternatives).
- Why this rating
- Pedagogy exhibits classical features through Paideia ties and a focus on memory, dialogue, and virtue formation, but public materials do not fully articulate a comprehensive, canonical classical pedagogy across all grades. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials identify roles (Head of School, Elementary/Middle School Principals, Dean of Students, etc.) and recruitment postings (Founding Teacher, Paideia Instructor, ML Interventionist) rather than a clear, explicit articulation of the faculty as “the living curriculum” or a portrait of teacher ideals.
- The materials emphasize professional roles and leadership structure, with occasional notes about mentorship and character via values, but do not consistently present a “faculty as living curriculum” or a formal teacher-profile standard.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Mentors, role models, professional collaboration are implied via leadership roles and staff recruitment, but explicit “living curriculum,” portrait of teachers, or collegial teacher community language is not strongly stated in public materials.
- Negative keywords present: Absence of explicit language about a teacher-as-living curriculum, explicit classical-teacher profile, or a formal teacher-virtue/character archetype in the public materials. The lexicon’s idealized faculty language is not clearly mirrored on the site.
- Why this rating
- While there are professional roles and a leadership structure, the public content lacks explicit articulation of teachers as the living curriculum or an explicit classical-faculty profile, which are central to a robust classical pedagogy framework. This results in a NOT CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site invites community involvement (Join Our Community, open communications, donation page, and family engagement themes). Founding/Paideia postings explicitly mention involving families in school life and aligning with a faith-based, family-centric approach.
- Public materials show a family-facing ethos (evangelized language around community, diversity, and unity; opportunities to connect with school through events and gatherings). The ML interventionist posting references communicating with multilingual families and fostering partnerships with diverse families.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Partnership with families, parent involvement, family formation, home-school connection, parental engagement, school-parent synergy, community of learners, hospitality.
- Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials.

- Why this rating
- There is explicit emphasis on parent involvement and community integration, including statements about inviting families into school life and partnership with families, aligning with the “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections”/“Cultural Transmission” lines in the Six Essentials lexicon. This supports CLASSICAL in Element 6.

Aggregate assessment

- Category ratings:
- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL
- General assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- What would move the needle (only if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)
- Make Great Books/Great Conversation explicit in the curriculum narrative, including named texts and a planned sequence tied to a liberal-arts framework.
- More explicitly articulate Trivium/Quadrivium components and their integration into grade-level curricula (e.g., grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, mathematics/music/astronomy integration).
- Elevate the explicit articulation of the faculty as the living curriculum (portrait of teachers, mentorship roles, and ongoing classical pedagogy professional development).
- Deepen liturgical or reflective practices in school life (clear, repeated mention of liturgical rhythm or communal worship in the classroom context, where appropriate).
- Expand the language of family formation and community partnership (documented rituals for parental formation, book studies, and regular parent gatherings tied to classical education principles).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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